

What the program does is set “Rules” for the processes running on your computer, and alert you if changes are made to these, or if any new processes are attempting to be opened. This way, if any malicious application is trying to enter or start on your computer, you will be shown an alert (from the system tray) and will be prompted for the action to be taken—whether to allow it or block it.

SSM may seem a little annoying at first, since when you open any application on your computer, be it your browser or your word processor, it will prompt you for an action. However, you can disable whatever rules you like.

The software is not very novice-friendly, and it takes a little time to get a hang of all the functionality it offers. Also, the latest version, 2.2.0.581, offers only a 30-day trial, after which you are asked to buy a registration key.

4.4.6 Microsoft Windows Defender Beta 2

[www.microsoft.com/athome/security/spyware/
software/default.msp](http://www.microsoft.com/athome/security/spyware/software/default.msp)

Microsoft released their very first free antispysware product—Windows Antispysware in December 2004. This was later renamed to Windows Defender and is now available as such. To download this, you need to use a genuine copy of Windows because this download comes under the Genuine Windows Advantage downloads from Microsoft in which your copy of Windows is verified online for its legality.

During the installation, you are asked whether you’d like to use the system’s default settings for SpyNet participation (see below) or choose other options. Being a Microsoft product, we were hardly surprised to note that its interface blended well with Windows XP’s. A toolbar at the top is used as the primary interface with Forward and Back buttons and buttons for Home, Scan, History, and so on.